

Lukas Hetzer | M.Sc.

University of Cologne – Department of Political Science
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🔍 Research & teaching interests

Topics: European integration, crisis politics, public opinion, political communication, digital policy

Methods: Quantitative research, large-scale data infrastructure, natural language processing, causal inference

🏛️ Academic positions & experience

Current

University of Cologne, Department of Political Science

Cologne (DE)

Doctoral Researcher

10/2022–present

Member of the Chair of European and Multilevel Politics (Prof. Dr. Sven-Oliver Proksch), involved in:

- Horizon 2020 project *Observatory for Political Texts in European Democracies; Work Package 5 - Parliamentary, government and legal texts* ([OPTED](#), [WP5](#))
- ERC project *Democracy without Majorities: Political Representation under Minority Rule* ([MINORITYRULE](#))
- Teaching (B.Sc. & M.Sc. level), thesis supervision (B.Sc. & M.Sc. level), and academic self-administration

Previous

Ludwig-Maximilians-University Munich, Geschwister-Scholl-Institute

Munich (DE)

Visiting Scholar

10/2024–11/2024

Hosted by the Chair of Political Systems and European Integration (Prof. Dr. Klaus Goetz).

GESIS – Leibniz Institute for the Social Sciences

Mannheim (DE)

Specialist for Data Management and Analysis

10/2021–09/2022

Member of the German Longitudinal Election Team, involved in:

- VW Foundation project *Threat to Democracy? Conspiracy Theories and their Impact on Voting Behavior* ([DemThreat](#))
- Outreach & Knowledge Transfer for the German Longitudinal Election Study ([GLES](#))

Ghent University, Department of Public Governance and Management

Ghent (BE) / remote

Research Intern

11/2020–05/2021

INAPP (Italy) project *Policy Interventions under Globalization and Technological Change*

University of Amsterdam, Amsterdam Institute for Social Science Research

Amsterdam (NL)

Research Assistant

10/2019–04/2021

Assistant to Prof. Dr. Theresa Kuhn, Challenges to Democratic Representation Research Group

Humboldt University Berlin, Department of Social Sciences

Berlin (DE)

Research Assistant

11/2017–08/2019

Assistant to Prof. Dr. Heike Klüver, Chair of Comparative Political Behavior

🎓 Education

University of Cologne, Cologne Graduate School

Cologne (DE)

PhD Political Science

10/2022–present

Thesis title: *Politics under Pressure: Crisis Governance, Decision-Making, and Public Responses*

Supervisors: Prof. Dr. Sven-Oliver Proksch & Prof. Dr. Alexia Katsanidou

University of Amsterdam, Amsterdam Institute for Social Science Research

Amsterdam (NL)

M.Sc. Social Sciences Research

09/2019–08/2021

GPA: 8.61 (excellent, highest distinction)

Thesis: *Regional Inequality and European Fiscal Solidarity in Times of Crisis: How Regional Wealth and Covid-19 Impact Shape Public Support for EU Risk Sharing*

Humboldt University Berlin, Department of Social Sciences

B.Sc. Social Sciences

GPA: 1.4 (excellent)

Thesis: *Position Taking in EU Parliament Speeches after the 2004 Enlargement: Adaptive Behavior of Newcomers measured through Legislative Speech*

Maastricht University, Faculty of Psychology and Neuroscience

B.Sc. Psychology (not completed)

Berlin (DE)

10/2016–07/2019

Maastricht (NL)

09/2015–08/2016

Awards & grants

Faculty of Management, Economics, and Social Sciences, University of Cologne

Junior Teaching Award (2,000€)

01/2026

Awarded by the Faculty Board based on outstanding student evaluations for the course *European Politics in Times of Crisis*

Reinhard Selten Institute (ECONtribute Cluster of Excellence)

Selten Grant (2,000€)

10/2024

Project: *Emergency Politics in the European Union*

Teaching

University of Cologne

Advanced Survey Methods and Challenges to Democracy (M.Sc.)

Summer 2025 & 2026

Survey methods (sampling, measurement, vignette & conjoint experiments, AI conversational interviewing, preregistration, ethics, analysis) and implementation in Qualtrics

University of Cologne

Tutorial Coordination: Foundations of European Politics (B.Sc.)

Summer 2025 & 2026

Recruiting, supervising and instructing a team of tutors; Organizing the content and structure of the tutorials (14 Groups) as part of the lecture "Foundations of European Politics" (Prof. Dr. Sven-Oliver Proksch)

University of Cologne

Digitalization & AI – Shaping the Future of European Politics and the Way We Study It (B.Sc.)

Winter 2025/26

Course on EU digital governance and regulation (AI Act, DSA), AI-assisted quantitative & qualitative research methods, and foresight methods

University of Cologne

European Politics in Times of Crisis (B.Sc.)

Summer & Winter 2024/25

Courses on crisis governance and rhetoric in the EU; include applied introductions to R

Thesis supervision & mentorship

University of Cologne

Supervision of B.Sc. theses (8 theses)

Supervision of M.Sc. theses (1 thesis)

Mentor & reference for BA students (3 students)

2024–2026

Publications

Journal articles (peer reviewed)

- [1] Riebe, Frauke; Wurthmann, Constantin; **Hetzer, Lukas** (2026). *Beyond Proximity: Representational Isolation and Emotional Response in Climate Politics*. *Representation*, 1–20.
- [2] **Hetzer, Lukas**; Burgoon, Brian (2024). *Regional crises and European fiscal preferences: how regional Covid-19, economic downturn, and migration shape support for EU risk sharing*. *Journal of European Public Policy*, 31(10), 3093–3127.

Working papers

- [1] **Hetzer, Lukas**. Expanding under Pressure? Crisis Rhetoric and EU Authority Expansion.
 - Journal of European Public Policy | Invited for contribution to the special issue "Navigating time pressure"

in the European Union”.

- [2] **Hetzer, Lukas**; Lenz, Alexa. The Efficiency-Deliberation Trade-Off of Crisis Politics: Evidence from Parliamentary Legislative Activity in Germany.
- [3] Anonymized for peer review
Under Review | European Journal of Political Research
- [4] Proksch, Sven-Oliver; **Hetzer, Lukas**; Wäckerle, Jens; Rath, Jasmin; Hoffmeyer-Zlotnik, Paula. Framing Minority Governments: How Strategic Narratives Shape Voter Evaluations.
- [5] Anonymized for peer review
R&R | British Journal of Political Science
- [6] Buzzelli, Gregorio; **Hetzer, Lukas**; Nicoli, Francesco; Sacchi, Stefano; Burgoon, Brian;. Who Governs Social Protection? The Political Legitimacy of Supranational Responses in the EU and Beyond.
 - Journal of European Public Policy | Invited for contribution to the special issue “A multi-level analysis of the EU’s social turn”.
- [7] Anonymized for peer review
Under Review | World Politics
- [8] Anonymized for peer review
Under Review | Party Politics
- [9] Anonymized for peer review
Under Review | Nature/Scientific Data

Edited volumes.....

- [1] Riebe, Frauke; **Hetzer, Lukas**; Wurthmann, Constantin (2022). *Die Bundestagswahl 2021: Perspektiven und Daten aus der deutschen Wahlstudie*. *easy_social_sciences* 67.

Contributions in edited volumes.....

- [1] Blumenberg, Manuela; Bieber, Ina; **Hetzer, Lukas**; Pollak, Reinhard; Stroppe, Anne-Kathrin (2024). *Pandemie und Wahlverhalten*. In: *Wahlen und Wähler: Analysen zur Bundestagswahl 2021*. Springer VS, 179–204.
- [2] Rossmann, Joss; Wurthmann, Constantin; Riebe, Frauke; **Hetzer, Lukas**; Blumenberg, Manuela (2022). *Einführung: Die Bundestagswahl 2021: Eine außergewöhnliche Wahl in ungewöhnlichen Zeiten*. In: *easy_social_sciences* 67, pp. 4–8.
- [3] Dippel, Alina S.; **Hetzer, Lukas**; Burger, Axel (2022). *Links oder rechts? Die ideologische Selbstverortung von Wähler:innen und ihre Wahrnehmung von Parteien in Deutschland*. In: *easy_social_sciences* 67, pp. 19–29.

Policy reports.....

- [1] Balduini, Sveva; Burgoon, Brian; Busemeyer, Marius; Gualtieri, Valentina; **Hetzer, Lukas**; Luppi, Matteo; Nicoli, Francesco; Sacchi, Stefano (2022). *Secular Economic Challenges and Public Support for Policy Interventions: Technological change and globalization in a randomized survey experiment in eight countries*. INAPP.

Datasets

- [1] Schwalbach, Jan; **Hetzer, Lukas**; Proksch, Sven-Oliver; Rauh, Christian; Sebők, Miklós (2025). *ParlLawSpeech*.

Reviewer

(Web of Science) Reviewer for *Journal of European Public Policy* (2x), *European Journal of Political Research* (1x), *European Union Politics* (2x), *Young Journal of European Affairs* (2x)

Conference participations & presentations

Invited talks.....	* upcoming
Computational Exchange Speaker Series (Prof. Haim), LMU Munich	2026*
Amsterdam Center for European Studies (Prof. Kuhn), University of Amsterdam	2025
Chair of Empirical Theories of Politics (Prof. Knill), LMU Munich	2025

Text-as-Data Reading Group (TaDa) Speaker Series, online	2025
Computational Social Science Doctoral Workshop, Sciences Po Paris	2024
Chair of Political Systems and European Integration (Prof. Goetz), LMU Munich	2024

Conferences

EPSS European Political Science Society	2026*
CES Council for European Studies Conference	2026*
ECPR Standing Group on Parliaments (SGoP)	2025
EPSA European Political Science Association Conference	2025, 2024, 2023
CompText Interdisciplinary Conference on Computational Text Analysis	2025, 2024, 2023
DVPW German Political Science Association Congress	2024
ECPR Standing Group on the European Union (SGEU)	2024
ECPR General Conference	2022

Workshops & colloquia

Navigating time pressure in the European Union, LMU Munich	2026
Cologne–Zurich–Innsbruck Political Science Workshop, Tratzberg	2026
A multi-level analysis of the EU's social turn, University of Konstanz	2026
Political Science Speaker Series, University of Cologne	2025
Gesis Workshop on validation of Large Datasets, online	2025
Cologne–Zurich European Politics Workshop, Filzbach	2024
Cologne Center for Comparative Politics Colloquium, University of Cologne	2023
OPTED Workshop	2022, 2023
Escaping the Politics Trap? EU Integration Pathways Beyond the Polycrisis, University of Amsterdam	2023
Political Representation and Behavior Workshop, University of Cologne	2023
EUI–YouGov “Solidarity in Europe” Survey Data Dissemination Workshop, EUI Florence	2023

Volunteer work

Active member of CorrelAid e.V.	2025–present
Election worker in German elections (federal- and state-level)	2025–present

Additional skills

Languages: English (native) · German (native) · Dutch (intermediate) · Italian (beginner)

Data analysis: R (expert) · Python (advanced) · Stata (advanced) · SPSS (basic)

Tools: GitHub · $\text{\LaTeX}$ / Overleaf · Qualtrics (advanced logic; JavaScript/HTML) · Microsoft Office

References

Prof. Dr. Sven-Oliver Proksch

Professor of European and Multilevel Politics
University of Cologne

sven-oliver.proksch@uni-koeln.de

Prof. Dr. Alexia Katsanidou

Professor of Empirical Social Research
Gesis Cologne & University of Cologne

alexia.katsanidou@gesis.org

Prof. Dr. Christian Rauh

Professor for the Politics of Multilevel Governance
WZB Berlin & University of Potsdam

christian.rauh@wzb.eu

Prof. Dr. Francesco Nicoli

Professor of Political Economy
Politecnico di Torino

francesco.nicoli@polito.it